

2018-Ph-H1-Q19

Section: Particles and Waves

Topic: Interference

Two coherent sound sources produce an interference pattern.

At a point of destructive interference, the path difference is:

- A. 1 wavelength
- B. $\frac{1}{2}$ wavelength
- C. 2 wavelengths
- D. 0 wavelengths

Solution:

Destructive interference occurs when the path difference is $\frac{1}{2}$ a **wavelength**, or any odd multiple of it.

Answer: B

Revision Tip:

- **Constructive:** path difference = $n\lambda$
- **Destructive:** path difference = $(n+\frac{1}{2})\lambda$